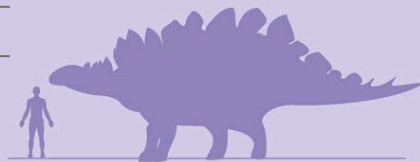


Spiky defense

Stegosaurus may have used its tail in fights to defend itself from predators such as this *Torvosaurus*. Paleontologists have found fossils of several *Stegosaurus* tail spikes with damaged and infected tips. Fossils of the carnivorous *Allosaurus*, which lived at the same time, also show gruesome injuries that fit the shape of *Stegosaurus*'s spikes.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 30 ft (9 m)
- **DIET** Herbivore
- **LIVED** 155–151 MYA
- **HABITAT** Forests



These large plates probably had more to do with attracting a mate than with defense.

